



Buffalo DriveStation Quattro

Good on features, low on appeal

The new Buffalo DriveStation Quattro crams in four 250 GB hard drives to give you a terabyte. Structurally rugged, this drive is encased in a rather bulky black casing, with all sides made of metal. Weighing in at 6 kg, it is tough to move around.

The drives are SATA150 at 7200 rpm. The accompanying software allows you to configure the drives to work in five different modes: Normal mode (appearing as four separate 250 GB drives), JBOD (which shows the drive as one contiguous 1 TB drive), RAID 0 (also appearing as a single 1 TB drive but faster), RAID 1 (500 GB with mirroring), and RAID 5 (750 GB and a

combination of speed and reliability).

The Quattro supports USB 2.0 and the newer and faster eSATA interface. Buffalo even provides a PCI eSATA card with a bracket and a cable for those—and that's the majority—whose motherboards do not support that interface.

It took 43 seconds for a 1 GB file to get copied to the drive; a gigabyte of assorted data took 52 seconds. The unit tends to heat up

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★



considerably during operation; the 12 cm fan at the back doesn't seem to be doing its job.

The Memeo Autobackup software that accompanies the drive is versatile. It automatically backs up your data to a wide variety of destinations such as hard disk, removable drive, FTP server, Network Places, iPod, and Memeo Internet Disk—an online service for Memeo

Backup users. Secure Lock Ware—another bundled application—uses 256-bit AES encryption to protect your data.

The absence of a backup button and the relatively slow speed bring down the appeal of the Quattro for system administrators, and the rather high price tag of Rs 49,000 doesn't help.

Specifications

1 TB (4 x 250 GB SATA); 7200 rpm; Seek time: 11 ms; Interface: USB 2.0, eSATA; eSATA PCI card with bracket; Software: Memeo Autobackup, Secure Lock Ware; Weight: 6 kg

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Price: Rs 49,000

Sennheiser RS130

Good. Very Good.

Wireless is generally a strict no-no for audiophiles. Enter the RS130, aimed at making believers out of the aurally-discerning that wireless headphones can indeed deliver the goods. Turns out they're not audiophile-grade, but they're good—much better than you'd expect wireless headphones to be. The major problem with all wireless headphones is interference, and the fact that air isn't as good (gross understatement!) a medium to transfer disturbance-free sound waves as compared to, say, 99.9% oxygen-free copper cables!

The RS130 comprises a transmitter unit with an AC power adapter, and the circumaural-type headphones that feel very light (280 gm) despite the rechargeable AAA NiMH batteries inbuilt. Surround sound is a switch away; the

RS130 employs additional circuitry for this. Sennheiser has also touted "Self Learning Volume Controller," a newfangled name for automatic volume levelling. We must say it works reasonably well here.

The headphones themselves are extremely comfortable on the outer ear—no stress or pressure even after five hours of continuous use for this reviewer. This is partially due to the ear-cup design and the extremely soft padding. These are open cans (others will hear the sound too).

The RS130 has an impressive soundstage for a wireless set. Audiophile cans

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

these are not, like we said, yet they impressed us with clarity and depth in almost every genre of music. You'll find low bass a little lacking in grunt, and mid-range seems a little muted, especially vocals. Still, this set downs every other wireless set we've tested in the past couple of years, and manages to give some of the good wired ones out there a run for their money.

Coming to the personal aspect, these cans are huge, and while they offer a superb range of around 16 metres—with obstacles including walls—we don't really see anyone walking around with them. Still, if wired is a no-no for you, give the RS130 a look—if you can handle the steep price: Rs 10,900. Remember we're talking about the best wireless set we've tested in years—and the brand image itself will do a little to massage your ego after the liquidity plunge! But do remember that if you're OK with a cord,



you'll find something acoustically similar at half the price.

Specifications

Circumaural; frequency range 18 Hz ~ 21 kHz; wireless RF receiver; surround sound mode; 3 RF channels

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Price: Rs 10,900